The furniture was old and unpleasant; the shower was a tin stall, where, we found, the water was bound to turn cold or hot depending on which taps were being opened or closed elsewhere in the building. There was no refrigerator and we would have to eat out. (There was the school cafeteria, fortunately, which was cheap, but had no other merit.)

It was our seventh move since marriage, and it was clear that our very first order of business would be to arrange an eighth move.

On June 1, 1949, I showed up at the Medical School and spent my first day at the job. It wasn't encouraging. I discovered that Bill Boyd, a full professor, was making $6,000. I seemed, financially, to be already near the top for an academic job. I doubted if I would ever make, even in a good writing year, as much as $10,000.

Oh well—so I would never be rich. My salary would do for a childless couple, especially since my savings had been slowly accumulating as a result of cautious and frugal living in the past and now stood at $6,200.

If, that is, the job continued. The trouble was it lacked security. My salary did not come out of Boston University funds. It was out of funds from government grants obtained by Lemon, and each year those

grants would have to be renewed or I would face the sudden kickout, as had been the case with Elderfield earlier in the year.

Gertrude was very aware of this and downcast over it. I tried to assure her that the grants would surely be renewed, but she said, "It will always be a matter of tension while we wait," and of course, that was true.

But we had to carry on, and apartment hunting was the order of the day. A solid week's search netted us something in Somerville, the town just north of Cambridge, which, in turn, was just across the Charles River, to the north of Boston.

It was in a pleasant neighborhood, on a busline that would take me to the elevated that would in turn take me to the school. (This was important, for we had no car and had to depend on mass transportation.) It was also near a shopping center and had a roomy and pleasant kitchen. The other three rooms were small and it was in an attic, two flights up. We beat the rent down from $85 a month to $75, and then put down a $10 deposit. We paid the first month's rent on June 20, and here we were with an apartment at 762 Broadway in Somerville, while still paying rent at Stuyvesant Town.